



TRUSTFORCE ADVISORS RESOURCE GUIDE

# Court Accounting Preparation Guide

*Preparing Organized Financial Records and Summaries*

**Important disclaimer:** TrustForce Advisors provides fiduciary support services and does not provide legal advice unless otherwise stated by a licensed attorney. These resources are for general educational and organizational purposes only. Laws, court requirements, fiduciary duties, and reporting rules may vary by state, court, agency, and case type. Always consult the court, your attorney, or a licensed professional regarding your specific situation.

**Purpose:** Court accountings help show how money was received, spent, saved, and managed. A well-prepared accounting protects the fiduciary, assists the court, and creates transparency. ---

## Section 1: Why Court Accounting Matters

### Court accounting may be required to

- Show income received
- Show expenses paid
- Confirm assets are protected
- Explain changes in balances
- Document fiduciary decisions
- Protect the vulnerable person
- Prevent misuse of funds
- Keep the fiduciary accountable

## Section 2: Records You Should Keep

### Income Records

#### Keep proof of

- ☐ Social Security
- ☐ SSI
- ☐ SSDI
- ☐ VA benefits
- ☐ Pensions
- ☐ Wages
- ☐ Rental income
- ☐ Interest
- ☐ Dividends
- ☐ Refunds
- ☐ Sale proceeds
- ☐ Insurance payments

### Expense Records

#### Keep proof of

- ☐ Rent or mortgage
- ☐ Utilities
- ☐ Food
- ☐ Medical bills
- ☐ Insurance
- ☐ Transportation
- ☐ Clothing
- ☐ Personal care
- ☐ Property repairs
- ☐ Taxes
- ☐ Professional fees
- ☐ Court costs

## Section 3: Monthly Transaction Ledger

#### Use this format

| Date | Description | Category | Deposit | Expense | Balance | Receipt? |
|------|-------------|----------|---------|---------|---------|----------|
|------|-------------|----------|---------|---------|---------|----------|

### Categories may include

- Housing
- Utilities
- Medical
- Transportation
- Food
- Insurance
- Taxes
- Personal needs
- Professional fees
- Property maintenance
- Court costs

## Section 4: Monthly Reconciliation

### Each month

- ☐ Compare ledger to bank statement
- ☐ Confirm beginning balance
- ☐ Confirm ending balance
- ☐ Match deposits
- ☐ Match expenses
- ☐ Identify missing receipts
- ☐ Explain unusual transactions
- ☐ File bank statement
- ☐ Save digital backup

## Section 5: Annual Accounting Preparation

### Before preparing the accounting

- ☐ Gather all bank statements
- ☐ Gather all receipts
- ☐ Print transaction ledger
- ☐ Summarize income by category
- ☐ Summarize expenses by category
- ☐ Update asset inventory
- ☐ Document asset sales
- ☐ Document major purchases
- ☐ Explain cash withdrawals
- ☐ Confirm ending balance

- ☐ Review with attorney or accountant, if needed

## Section 6: Common Accounting Errors

### Avoid

- Missing receipts
- Missing bank statements
- Unexplained cash withdrawals
- Math errors
- Duplicate entries
- Personal purchases
- Missing beginning balance
- Missing ending balance
- Not separating income and expenses
- Not explaining transfers
- Waiting until the deadline to organize records

## Section 7: Court Accounting Submission Checklist

- ☐ Accounting period confirmed
- ☐ Beginning balance listed
- ☐ Income summarized
- ☐ Expenses summarized
- ☐ Ending balance listed
- ☐ Bank statements attached
- ☐ Receipts organized
- ☐ Asset inventory updated
- ☐ Unusual transactions explained
- ☐ Attorney reviewed, if applicable
- ☐ Copies saved
- ☐ Deadline confirmed

## Need Help Managing Fiduciary Responsibilities?

TrustForce Advisors provides professional support for conservators, guardians, trustees, veteran fiduciaries, families and caregivers, attorneys, and professionals.

**Schedule a consultation today.**

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